

Plagiarism and How to Avoid It

The work you submit for assessment must be your own. If you try to pass off the work of others as your own, whether deliberately or not, you will be committing plagiarism (this includes failing to use proper citation methods when citing or paraphrasing work that is not your own). If you reuse work that you have submitted for assessment elsewhere, whether deliberately or not, you will be committing self-plagiarism.

Any quotation from the published or unpublished works of other persons, including other students, must be clearly identified as such, being placed inside quotation marks. A full reference to all sources must be provided in proper form. A series of short quotations from several different sources, if not clearly identified as quotations, constitutes plagiarism just as much as an unacknowledged long quotation from a single source. All paraphrased material must also be clearly and properly acknowledged.

Any written work you produce (for classes, seminars, exam scripts, dissertations, formative/summative essays, computer programmes) must be solely your own. You must not employ a “ghost writer” to write parts or all of the work, whether in draft or as a final version, on your behalf. For further information see the School’s [Statement on Editorial Help](#). Any breach of the Statement will be treated in the same way as plagiarism.

You should also be aware that a piece of work may only be submitted for assessment once. Submitting the same piece of work twice – such as, for example, using all or part of a formative essay in an assessed essay - will be regarded as an offence of “self-plagiarism” and will also be treated in the same way as plagiarism.

Examiners are vigilant for cases of plagiarism and the School uses the plagiarism detection software [Turnitin UK](#) to identify plagiarised text. Work containing plagiarism may be referred to an Assessment Misconduct Panel which may recommend severe penalties. The Regulations on Plagiarism can be found at the following web links:

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http://www.lse.ac.uk/intranet/LSEServices/TQARO/Calendar/RegulationsAssessmentOffences_Plagiarism.pdf

If you are unsure about the academic referencing policy used by the School you should seek guidance from your Academic Adviser or from the Library via [Library Subject Guides](#).

Turnitin

All MSc assessed essay and dissertation submissions will be run through Turnitin. The work you submit for assessment must be your own. If you try to pass off the work of others as your own, whether deliberately or not, you will be committing plagiarism (this includes failing to use proper citation methods when citing or paraphrasing work that is not your own). If you reuse work that you have submitted for assessment elsewhere, whether deliberately or not, you will be committing self-plagiarism. Please read page 46 of the [MSc Student Handbook](#) for further details.

What is plagiarism?

Plagiarism is passing off somebody else's work as your own. This includes, but is not limited to:

- Quoting word-for-word without using quotation marks
- Quoting word-for-word without referencing (citing) your sources
- Summarising, rewriting or paraphrasing without citing your sources

Plagiarism is a serious offence and could result in the student being severely penalised.

For more information on plagiarism, students should refer to the [School regulations](#). The documents listed below are especially relevant and should be read in full.

- [General Academic Regulations](#)
- [Regulations on assessment offences: plagiarism](#)
- [Regulations for Taught Masters degrees \(MSc\)](#)

Library Workshops

Continued over

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We encourage all students to make use of the [information skills workshops](#) run by the LSE Library. Here you can access a range of support on:

- How to add citations and build a bibliography
- Using EndNote and EndNote Online to manage your references
- Literature searching and finding journal articles
- Exploring government data sources and archives

LSE LIFE

LSE Life offer a range of workshops and other resources to help students avoid plagiarism. Further details about these can be found by visiting the [LSE LIFE Moodle page](#).